

Maya Gerdes

mjgerdes@umich.edu | 973-634-1419 | linkedin.com/in/mayagerdes | github.com/mjmgerdes | mayagerdes.com

EDUCATION

University of Michigan - Ann Arbor, MI

GPA: 3.96/4.00 | Expected May, 2028

Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience, Honors Program; Minor in Business, Ross School of Business; Minor in Entrepreneurship

Honors: William J. Branstrom Prize, James B. Angell Scholar, Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society, National Neuroscience Honor Society

EXPERIENCE

Praxigen, Founder & Technical Builder - Ann Arbor, MI / Remote

Apr. 2026 - Present

- Founded AI-native prior authorization infrastructure startup targeting specialty medical practices, conducting 30+ customer discovery interviews to design product roadmap and coordinate product pilots across the US while managing 5-person team
- Built and deployed full-stack product (Next.js, Supabase, Vercel) serving clinical note checker, appeal letter generator, case management workflows, and administrative insights dashboard, while integrating compliance research into product for launch
- Accelerated by University of Michigan Ross School of Business UStart League (<0.02% acceptance rate)

Michigan Blockchain Consulting, Project Manager - Ann Arbor, MI

Aug. 2025 - Present

- Served as Project Manager and Business Analyst for 4 SMB clients in blockchain infrastructure space, delivering software solutions and GTM strategy by evaluating scalability, cost structure, positioning, and adoption barriers in decentralized storage
- Drove go-to-market analysis in collaboration with technical teams, translating complex technical insights into client-facing recommendations, update overviews, demos, and integration strategies across rollups, L2 networks, and middleware partners
- Produced market analysis and GTM strategy for MODEX, shaping product projected to reach 10K+ users in year one

Michigan Medicine, Department of Human Genetics, Research Assistant - Ann Arbor, MI

Aug. 2025 - May 2026

- Conducted research on programmable DNA sensing systems using CRISPR-based platforms to detect cancer-specific genomic alterations and trigger targeted gene circuit activation and cellular responses in mammalian cells
- Designed and executed experimental workflows to test CRISPR-based sensing constructs, using SnapGene to engineer plasmid design and experimental data to diagnose construct-level issues and iteratively refine system performance

Neuropsychiatry & Forensic Neurology Private Practice, Intern - New York City, NY

May 2025 - Aug. 2025

- Engaged in outpatient neuropsychiatric and forensic neurology clinical workflows, including diagnostic evaluations, cognitive assessments, and treatment planning, while assisting with patient flow across 50+ diverse cases
- Contributed to forensic neuropsychiatric evaluations in collaboration with a physician serving as an expert witness, supporting structured interviews, behavioral assessment, and case development for court proceedings

Michigan Medicine & College of Engineering, Research Assistant - Ann Arbor, MI

Nov. 2024 - Sept. 2025

- Conducted translational research across computational vascular biomechanics lab and clinical research in cardiovascular surgery, integrating computational approaches to improve vascular imaging & reconstruction in surgical planning
- Analyzed and organized pre- and post-operative CABG and cardiac catheterization datasets using Epic and Excel to inform statistical analysis and data-driven clinical research on patient outcome prediction and improvement

LEADERSHIP

Cancer Screening Advocates, President & Founding Campus Lead - Ann Arbor, MI

Nov. 2025 - Present

- Launched first university chapter of national nonprofit, building partnership with Michigan Medicine Cancer Center to execute campus-wide education and fundraising initiatives while developing scalable frameworks for future university chapters

Pi Sigma Epsilon, Ross Professional Business Fraternity, Speaker Chair - Ann Arbor, MI

Jan. 2025 - May 2026

- Organized and hosted university-wide and fraternity-exclusive speaker events featuring industry professionals and alumni, coordinating outreach, logistics, and event execution to advance professional development for 120+ members

Phi Delta Epsilon, Medical Fraternity, Finance & Professional Development Chair - Ann Arbor, MI

Sept. 2025 - Present

- Research and distribute scholarship, employment, and financial resources for fraternity members, building centralized interface for databases, facilitating grant applications, and organizing professional skills workshops for 160+ members

ADDITIONAL

Technical Skills: Cursor, Lovable, Supabase, Vercel, GitHub, Figma, Airtable, Jira, basic Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Data analysis & statistics (R, Excel, Python, C++); UI/UX (Cursor, Lovable); experimental & translational research

Skills: PowerBI, Tableau, Jira, Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, Powerpoint, etc.), Figma, Market Research (GTM, Competitive Analysis)

Interests: HealthTech, Entrepreneurship, Pickleball, Music (piano, guitar, DJing), Cognitive Sciences, Human-Computer Interaction